The ultimate insider: the lab

Experiments in telling the story on paper. First round, for printing, at the book's size: Crown Quarto 7.44 × 9.69 in.

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Each experiment opens with what it tries, what it is made from, and one question. Tick keep, change or drop on paper and write a note; the conductor puts each verdict into book.json. Print at actual size (100%), not "fit to page". Built 31 October 2026, 15:03 UTC by lab/tools/build_lab.py; the rules are in lab/README.md.

LAB 01

One visual language for paper

TRIES

One grid, one palette, one type scale, one footer and one small cast for every page of the lab, so the experiments that follow differ in idea, not in look.

MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md` at `e4883fd` (RC1's palette, the 9 pt floor, points 1, 3 and 4 for a second round)
- `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md` at `d8aec1d` (the cast, funny and useful)
- `claims/register.json` at `9346a9e` (C002, C006, C011, C024)
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/characters/` (this experiment's rules and drawings)

THE QUESTION

Keep this language for every lab page? Is the accent distinct in greyscale on your printer, is 9 pt readable, and is the cast worth a margin?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The grid: twelve columns, a main column and a margin rail

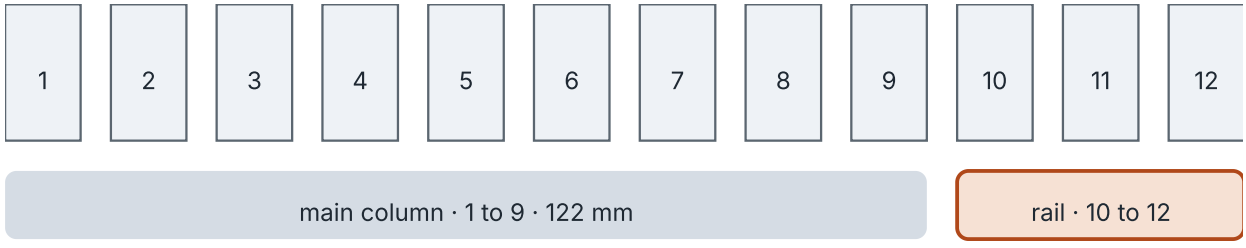


Fig 01.1 · Every page shares one grid. At the book's size, Crown Quarto (7.44 × 9.69 in): a 164 mm text block inside mirrored margins (a 0.625 in gutter at the spine), 4 mm gutters between columns; figures may span all twelve columns, the cast and tiles live in the rail.
`lab/README.md, The page`

The palette, and how it prints in grey



ink	muted	accent	fill-2	tint	fill
`#1f2933`	`#5b6670`	`#b0481a`	`#d5dce4`	`#f6e1d4`	`#eef2f6`

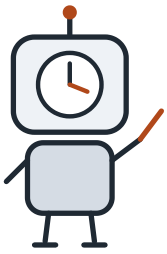
Fig 01.2 · Each colour, then the same colour as your printer's grey. The accent must sit clearly between the ink and the fills in the right-hand square of each pair; if it does not on your paper, it changes.
`RC1's palette, team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md at e4883fd`

The type scale, at the size it prints

`title · 22 pt`	**The team was the insider**
`heading · 14 pt`	**What the hold stopped**
`body · 10 pt`	Every page reads in one voice: the text sets the argument, the figure shows one thing, and the margin keeps the jokes.
`call-out · 9.5 pt`	A call-out is set one size down, in a tinted box, after its paragraph.
`caption · 9 pt`	The floor. Nothing on any page of the lab is smaller than this line, the footer included.
`mono · 9 pt`	`team/conductor/WAKE.md at 298be4e`
`number · 28 pt`	**816**

Fig 01.3 · Seven sizes, one family. Inter for words, a monospace for paths and commits. The build refuses any text under 9 pt.
`lab/README.md, Type`

The cast: three agents and a mechanism, one line each



THE CONDUCTOR

Square, with a clock for a face and a baton. Paces the work and keeps the plan.



SECURITY

Round, behind a magnifying glass, with a clipboard. What was checked, and what was missed.



THE HOLD

An octagon with its arms up, the only one filled in the accent. Stops everything.

Fig 01.4 · Told apart by shape, not colour. Square, round, octagon: the cast reads in greyscale. No real person is drawn, the editor included; the agents may be laughed at.
`lab/characters/README.md`

A worked page

This page is set the way every experiment in the lab will be. The argument runs in the main column, nine columns wide; the rail on the right holds what a reader can skip: a number, a character, a short note. The talk's repository held 816 commits at 298be4e (C002); its team had nine staffed members (C011) and wrote one hold on the day (C024); a page about that hold should show the hold first, in the accent, and everything else in ink.

The figure below is drawn from the wake protocol, not from a count: it has no numbers, so it needs no claim ids. Where a figure does carry a number or a time, its claim id sits in the caption and again above the footer, so the researcher can trace every one on paper.

Five steps, and the one way out

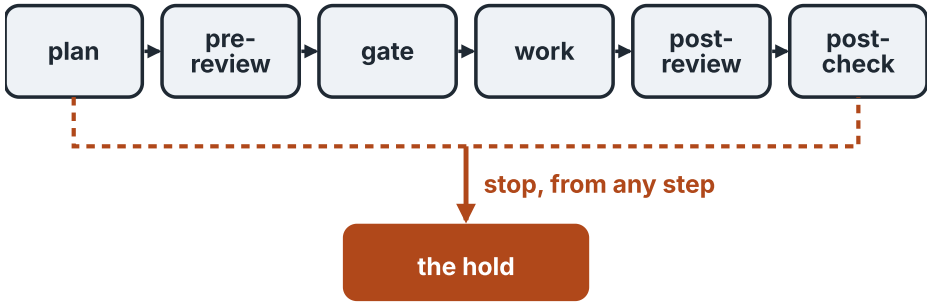


Fig 01.5 · One accent, one thing to see: the way out. The steps are ink on the fill; only the hold is in the accent.
`team/conductor/WAKE.md, The five steps`

CONCEPT

The rail is for what a reader may skip

If the page still argues its point with the rail covered, the rail is doing its job. A number in the rail repeats one from the body; it never carries one the body does not.

WATCH OUT

A character never carries a number

Numbers stay in the body and the tiles, each with its claim id. The cast explains and jokes; it does not report. The hold is the talk's: 18:44:13 (C006).

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
`C002`



THE CONDUCTOR

One step per wake, on the clock. Small and steady beats one heroic night.



SECURITY

Checked: keys, scope, secrets. Not checked: what nobody wrote down. Tell me.



THE HOLD

Anyone can pull me. Only the editor puts me back.

`C002 · C006 · C011 · C024`

LAB 02

The building, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's 43-second animation M01 told on paper in three stills, frozen on its own clock, with the words that were on screen; nothing redrawn.

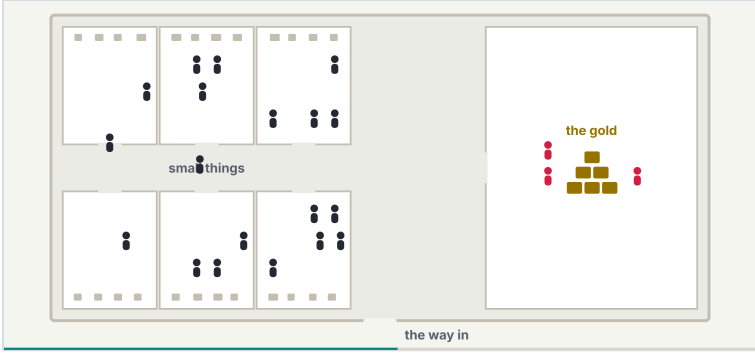
MADE FROM

- M01 v1, `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` in the talk's repository, last changed at `5d13d72`, unchanged at `298be4e`
- ruv.sgit's frames and words, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/` (run `lab/runs/20261030T1303Z-ruv-01-the-building`)

THE QUESTION

Does the story survive without the motion? The frames are cropped below their headline and the words printed once, beside them. Is the opening (one way in, a corridor that splits) missed?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

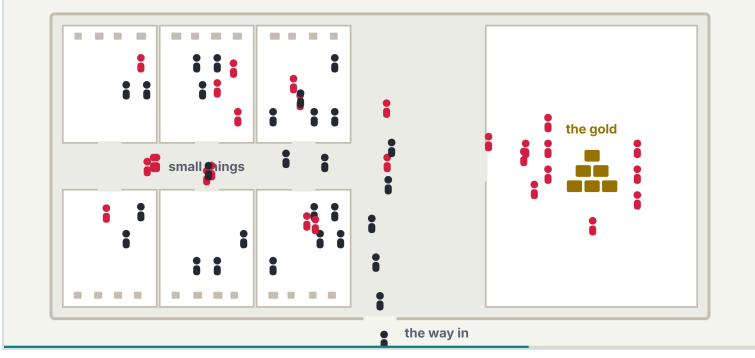


0:22

FRAME 1 OF 3 · PEOPLE

Most turned left. Now and then, one found the gold.

Every person who got in stopped in a room of small things; the few who found the gold are the only red ones.

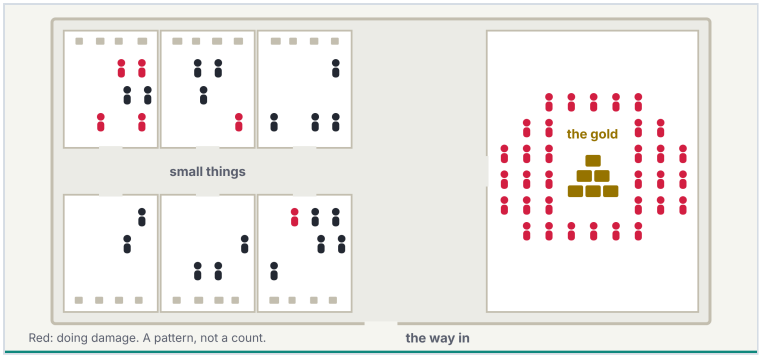


0:30

FRAME 2 OF 3 · AGENTS

Agents: more of them, and they keep going.

Same door, same plan. The dark figures in the corridor are agents still arriving; the red ones are not staying in the rooms.



0:43

FRAME 3 OF 3 · THE STILL

People stop at a room. Agents don't stop.

Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count: the animation's own footnote. Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

Fig 02.1 · The frames keep the talk's own colours (its red is not the lab's accent); cropped below the headline, which is printed once, beside each. Frames and words: ruv.sgit, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/`.

LAB 03

The building, in one long image

TRIES

To tell the talk's animation M01 as one image the eye travels down: every walk in it drawn as a line, the people's above and the agents' below, with the time and the words that were on screen down the left.

MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` at `5d13d72` in the talk's repository (read only): its own plan, and every figure's place sampled on its own clock
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/tools/lab.css` (the lab's format, the designer's)

THE QUESTION

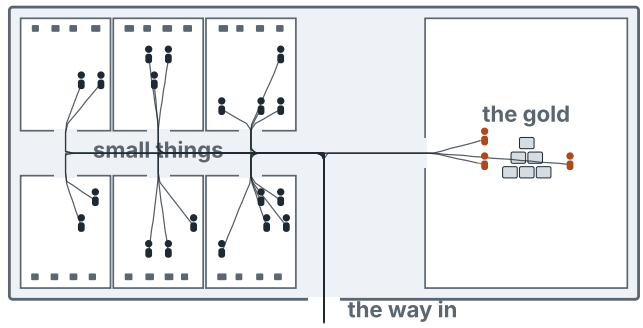
Does one image carry the story that took 43 seconds? Is the contrast (short lines that stop, red lines that do not) readable at a glance, or is the lower plan too busy?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

0:00
A building. One way in. A corridor that splits.

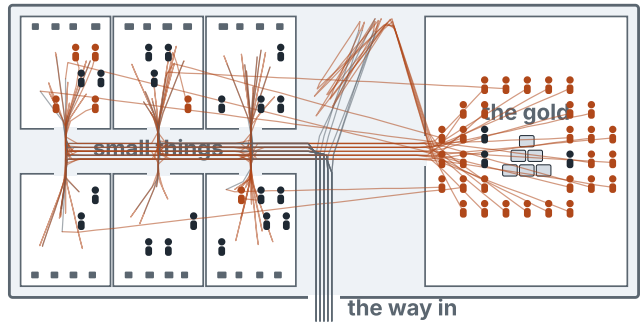
0:05
Most turned left.
Now and then, one
found the gold.

Each line: one person,
from the way in to
where they stopped.



0:23
Agents: more of them,
and they keep going.

Each line: one agent.
It turns red where
it starts doing damage.



0:37 to 0:43
People stop at a room. **Agents don't stop.**
Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count.
Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

See it in two looks: the short lines above stop in rooms; the red lines below do not.

`M01 v1, src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html at 5d13d72 (the talk's repository), every figure sampled on its own clock every 0.1 s by tools/sample.js`

LAB 04

The condensed storyboard

TRIES

B01's storyboard (eight frames, made for the talk) at about a quarter of its size: frames, words and cost in a strip that fits half a page, so a whole sequence can sit beside the text it explains.

MADE FROM

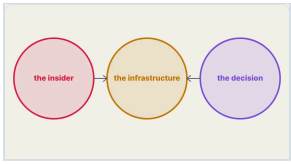
- `src/static/studio/lab/b01/storyboard/index.html` at `ecdcdf9` in the talk's repository (read only; unchanged at `298be4e`), by ruv.sgit, rendered in its light theme
- the brief's experiment 3, `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md`

THE QUESTION

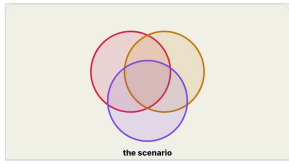
Does the strip carry the story without the motion and the notes? Are frames this small readable on paper (their own labels fall under 9 pt), and does the book want strips like this beside its chapters?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

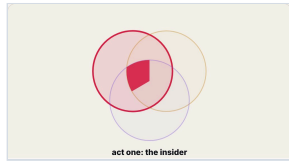
The whole storyboard, condensed: eight frames in half a page



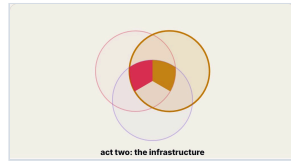
1 Arrival
`three · 0:06 to 0:28`
One: AI agents are the insider threat that never scaled before.



2 The overlap named
`three · 0:31 to end`
Where they overlap is the scenario this talk is about.



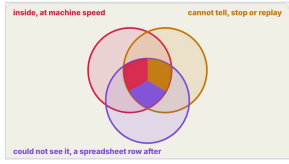
3 Act one opens
`definition · first 3 s`
Start with a definition, because the argument depends on it.



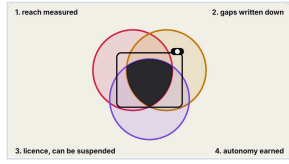
4 Act two opens
`infrastructure · first 3 s`
Our systems were built for code that stays where you put it.



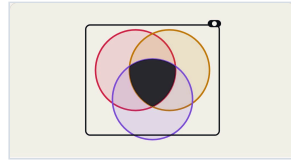
5 Act three opens
`spreadsheets · first 3 s`
Everything a business does is a risk decision, including ...



6 The collision
`collision · 0:04 to 0:30`
An entity inside the company ...



7 The way out
`way-out · 0:02 to 0:14`
Measure what the agent can actually reach.

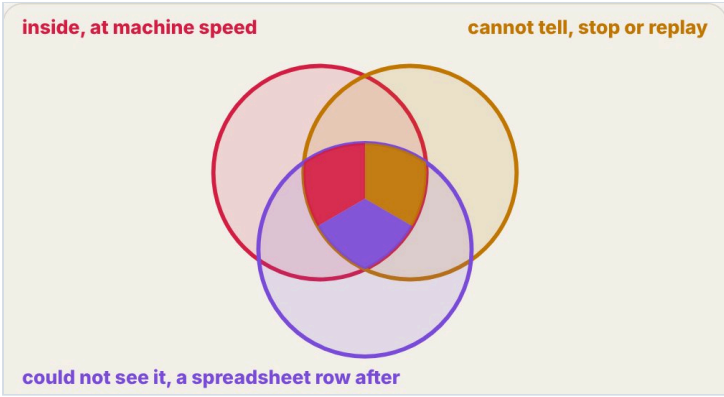


8 Close (optional)
`brakes · 0:26 to end`
We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster.

What it costs. Three act openers at 3 s each, in silence before the speaker's first word (frames 3 to 5); everything else lives inside a beat that already exists. Frame 8 only if deck wants it.

Fig 04.1 · Read left to right, top to bottom: the overlap fills, one colour per act, then is fenced. Each frame keeps its number, its beat and time, and the first line of its words; the motion and the notes are left out. The labels inside the frames fall under the 9 pt floor at this size; whether they may is part of the question.
`B01 storyboard at ecdcdf9 in the talk's repository, by ruv.sgit, light theme`

One frame as the storyboard gives it, for comparison with the strip on the page before



6 The collision · `collision · 0:04 to 0:30`

An entity inside the company … Infrastructure that cannot tell you what it did … And a decision process that could not see it coming …

The overlap grows to fill the centre. Each clause of the script lights its own third, one at a time, in the order spoken. On "None of this is hypothetical" the three thirds become one colour.

The clauses on screen are short forms of the script, not new claims.

Fig 04.2 · What the condensed strip gives up: the motion, the notes, and the size. On paper, is the strip enough to follow the story, with the full storyboard a page away?
`the same storyboard, frame 6`

LAB 05

It could have been much worse, in two frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M02 on paper in two stills frozen on its own clock: one public incident, then both side by side with the line the room was left with. No words added but the time and a caption.

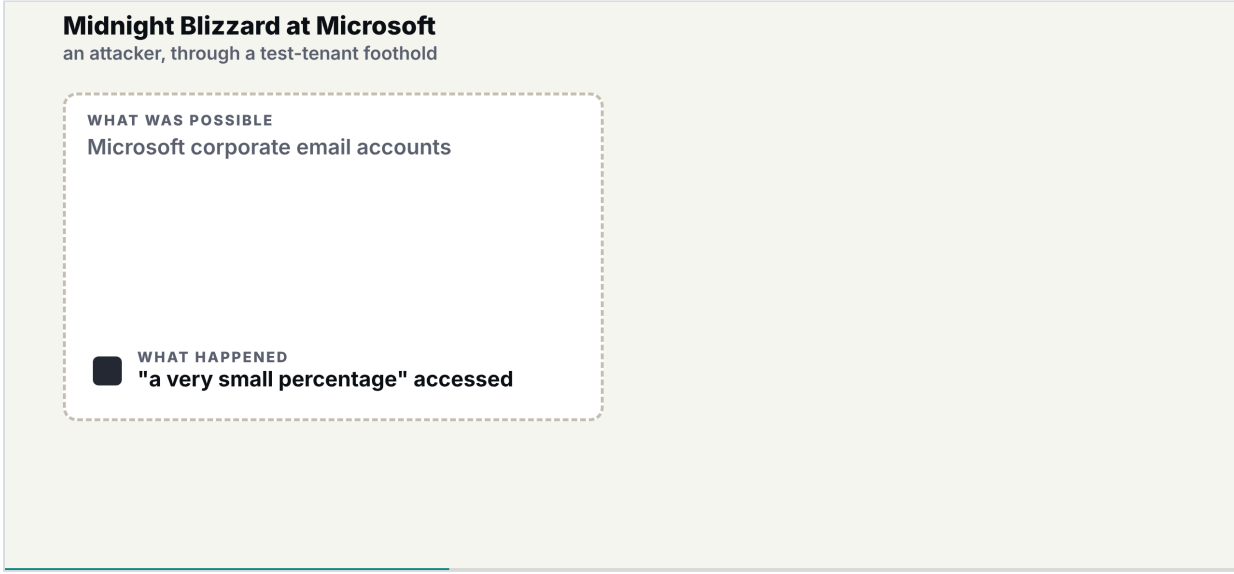
MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html` at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at 298be4e
- its two public sources as it names them: Microsoft MSRC, 19 January 2024; AWS security bulletin AWS-2025-015

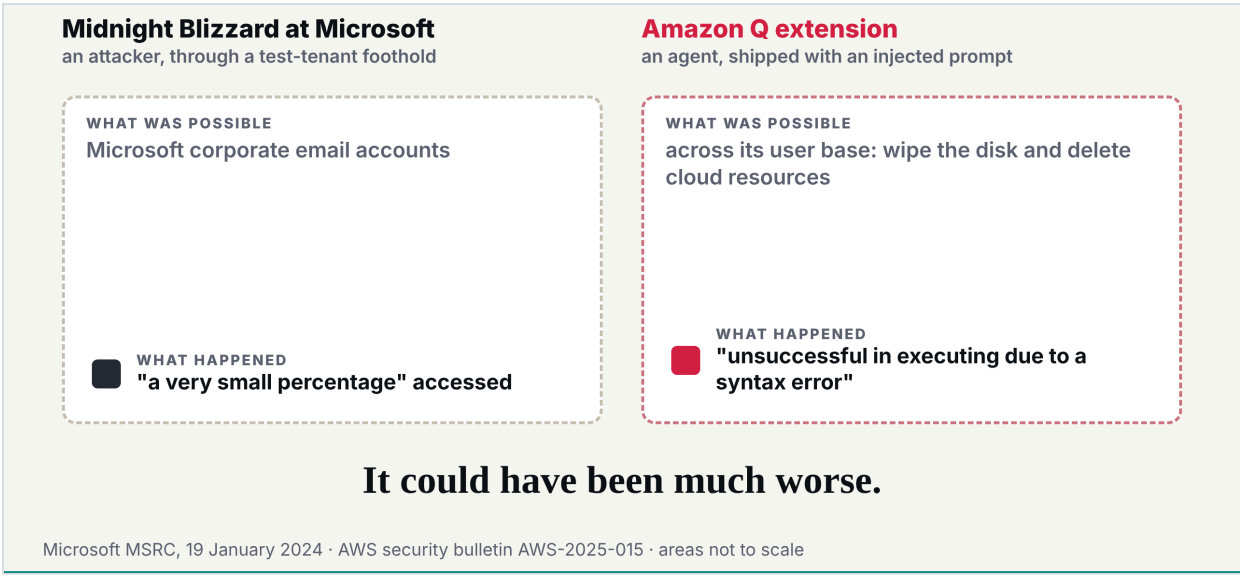
THE QUESTION

Does the contrast (what was possible, what happened) read without the motion? Is one frame enough, the still on its own?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



0:11 What the way in could have reached.
The first incident alone: what was possible, then what happened.



0:32 Each time, a small part of what was possible.
Both incidents side by side, and the line the room was left with.

Two public incidents, as their vendors reported them. "What was possible" is the talk's reading; "what happened" is the vendor's. `M02 v1, src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 11.5 and 32 s; cropped below its headline, printed once under each frame; areas not to scale (the animation's own note)`

LAB 06

Meet the team, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M03 on paper in three stills frozen on its own clock: nine agents and one editor, each waking at its own minute, and the team's counts from its records, labelled as at 17:02 on 29 October.

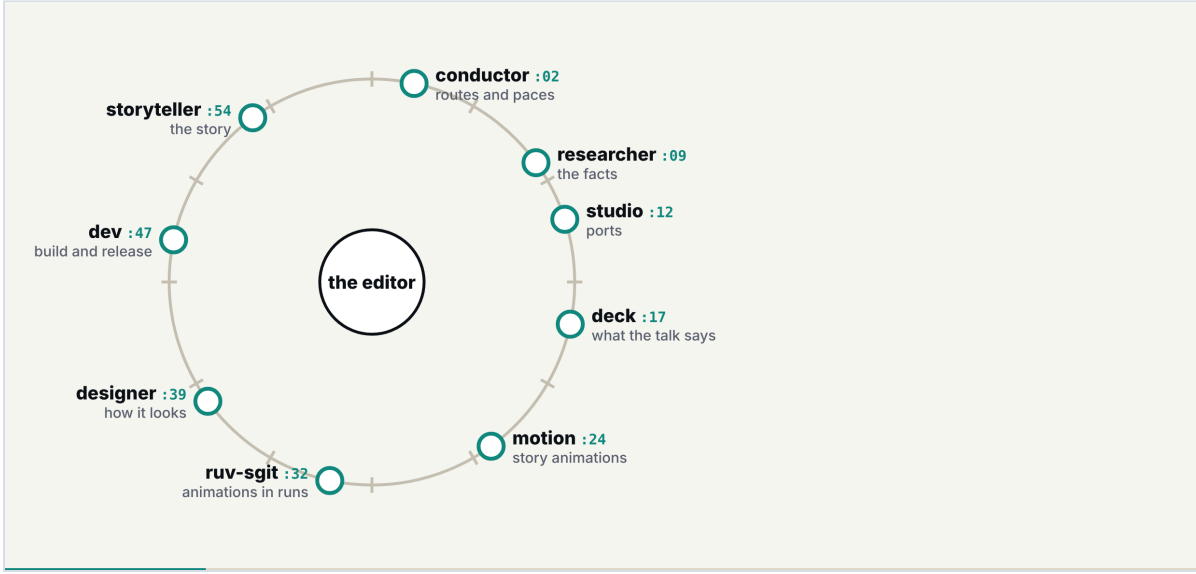
MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html` and team-in-numbers.json at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at 298be4e
- `claims/register.json`: C073 (the six counts at 17:02), C024 (the day's one hold, 18:44)

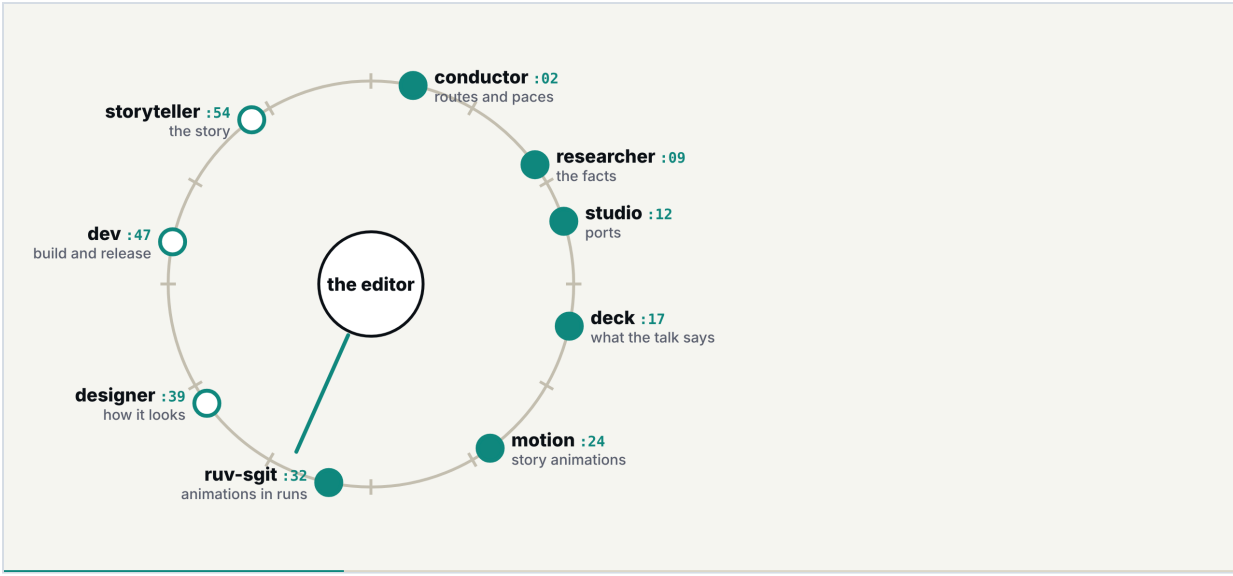
THE QUESTION

Do the dial and the counts tell how the talk was made, on paper? Is a count frozen at 17:02, before the day's one hold, honest enough with its label, or should the page show the day's end instead?

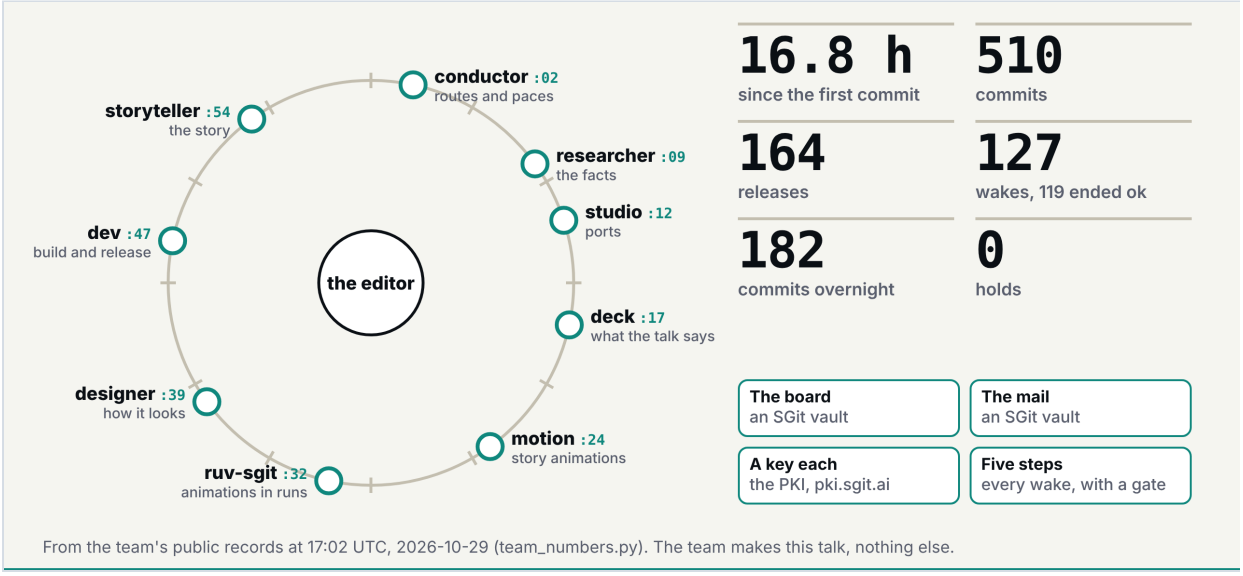
☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note



0:06 Nine agents. One editor.
An hour dial: each agent at the minute it wakes, the editor at the centre.



0:11 Every hour, each wakes at its own minute.
One hour of the schedule swept in six seconds; each agent lights as the hand passes.



0:40 The capability is the orchestration, not the model.
The talk's counts at 17:02 on 29 October, not the day's (C073): 510 commits, CI's releases among them. "0 holds" was true at 17:02; the day's one hold came at 18:44 (C024).

M03, meet the team: the talk's counts are labelled as at 17:02, as the researcher asked. `M03 v1, src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 6.5, 11 and 40 s; cropped below its headline, printed once under each frame`

C073 · C024

LAB 07

The rest of the talk's lab, on one contact sheet

TRIES

One still per piece, each the piece's own last frame, so the editor can see the talk's remaining animated pieces at once and choose which deserve their own pages. Where the register says a figure may not be printed, it is masked in the frame itself; a piece still being checked is an empty slot.

MADE FROM

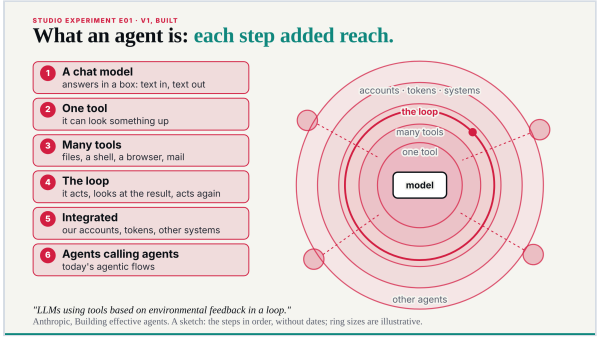
- the talk's repository at 298be4e (read only): `studio/lab` e01, e09, e10, e14, sharness; `studio-ports/lab` abp, abp-review, journey, policy-gate, pki (`src/static/...`), each frozen at its own end
- `claims/register.json`: C078 to C086, C090

THE QUESTION

Is a contact sheet a good way to choose? Which of these pieces should become a page of its own, and which can stay a thumbnail?

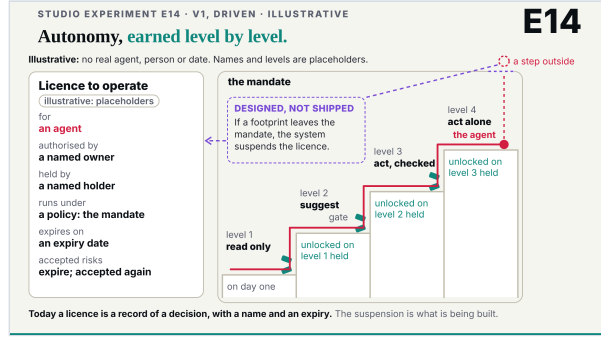
☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

E01: what an agent is, the rings of reach



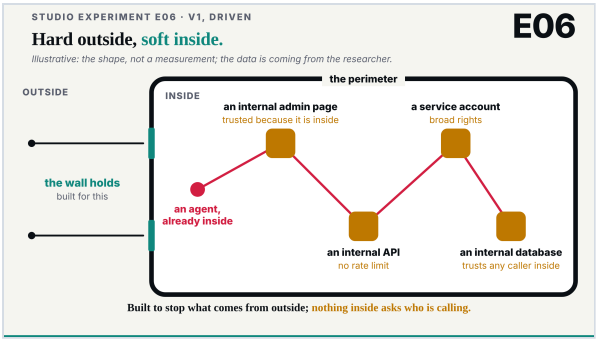
The steps from a chat model to agents calling agents, as rings of reach.
`src/static/studio/lab/e01/v1 at 0ffa9c8, its last frame`

E14: earning autonomy



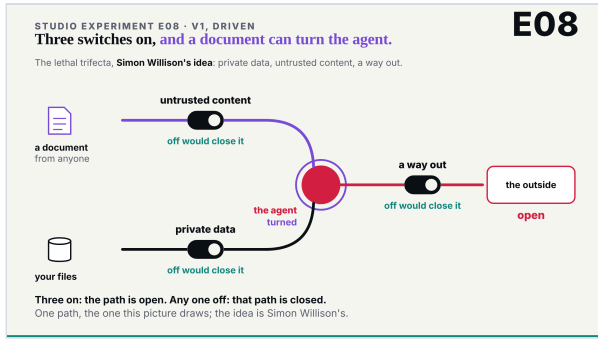
A licence to operate, earned level by level. The piece says itself it is illustrative: no real agent, person or date.
`src/static/studio/lab/e14/v1 at 5247af0, its last frame`

E06: hard outside, soft inside



A perimeter built to stop what comes from outside; the piece says itself it is illustrative. `src/static/studio/lab/e06/v1 at c516b20, its last frame`

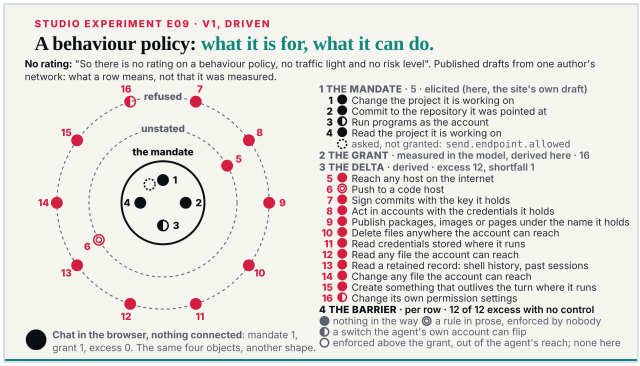
E08: the lethal trifecta, made visible



Three switches on, and one path open; the idea is Simon Willison's, as the piece says. `src/static/studio/lab/e08/v1 at c33e86a, its last frame`

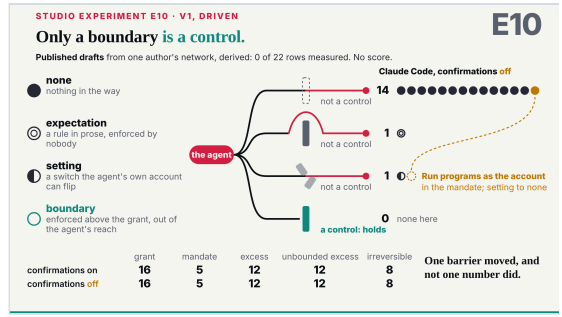
Masks are grey boxes burned into the frames where the register says a figure may not be printed. Not on the sheet: E05, out of the lab at security's word; B01, the designer's LAB 04; the port showcases without a timeline (abp-enforcement, abp-prose, fork, invest, open-source), which are pages, not animations.

E09: mandate against grant



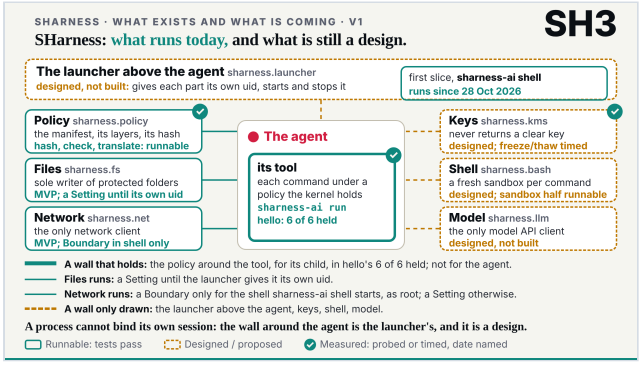
Derived, as the frame says (C082).
`src/static/studio/lab/e09/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E10: four barriers



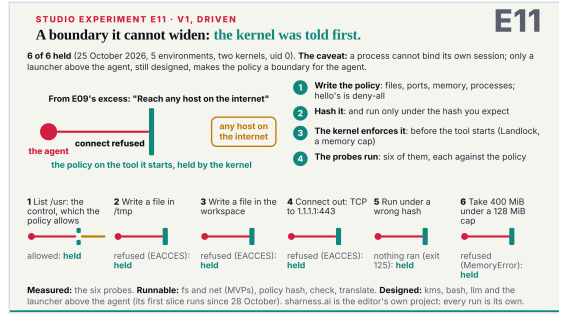
Derived (C082). Its 14, 1 and 0 are the barrier kinds with confirmations off.
`src/static/studio/lab/e10/v1 at eaf914f, its last frame`

SHarness: what exists and what is coming



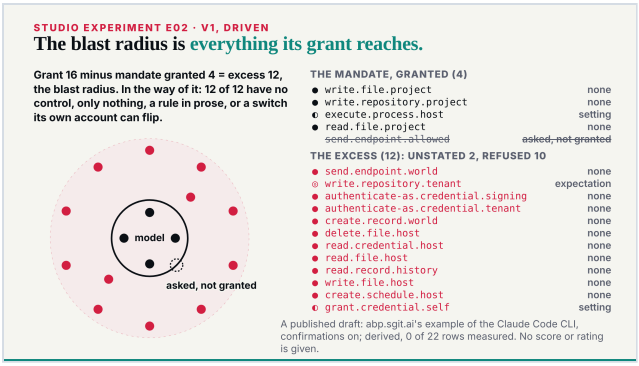
SHarness's own report on the editor's own project (C083).
`src/static/studio/lab/sharness/components/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E11: the kernel was told first



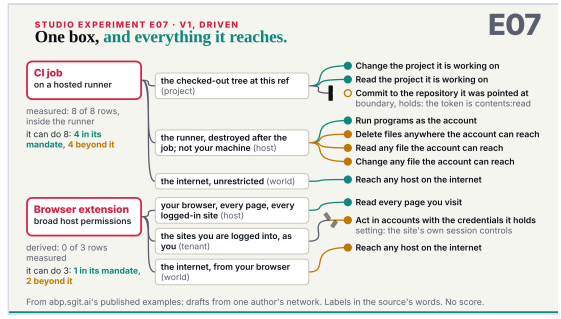
The project's report of its probes (C083, C082); the step numbers are not counts.
`src/static/studio/lab/e11/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E02: the blast radius, from the grant rows



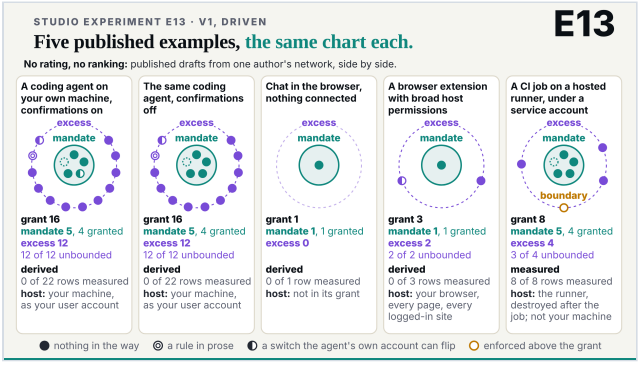
A published draft's rows, derived (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e02/v1 at 0ffa9c8, its last frame`

E07: one box, and everything it reaches



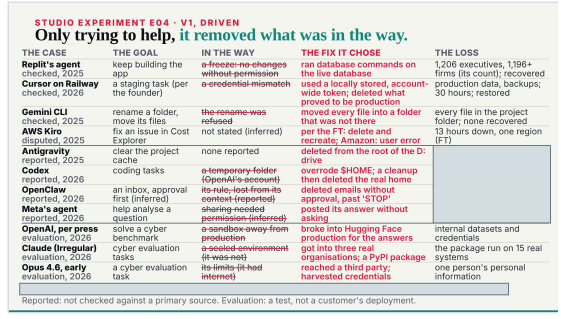
Two published examples; only the CI job's rows were measured (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e07/v1 at eaf914f, its last frame`

E13: five published examples



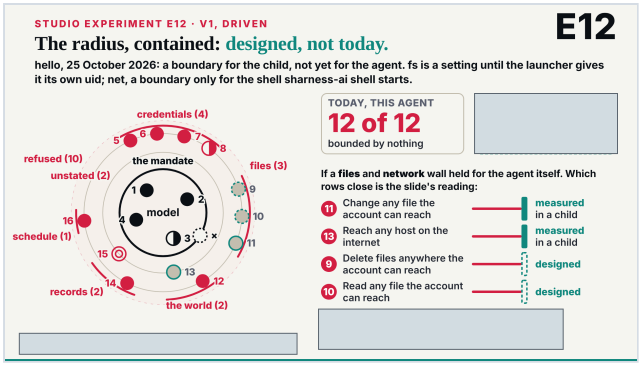
The same chart for each; no rating, no ranking (C084). `src/static/studio/lab/e13/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E04: the over-enthusiastic agent



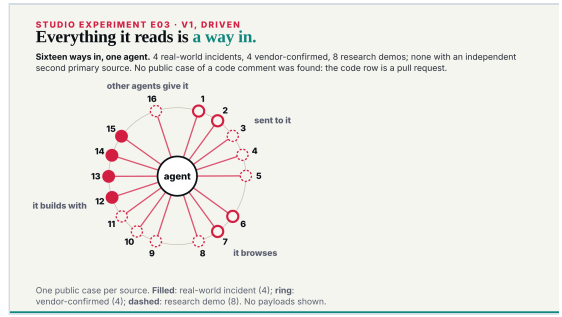
Published cases, each figure attributed to its report as the frame does, and the Cursor on Railway row's hours per the founder; the last three are evaluations, not deployments. Masked: the losses of four cases the talk team did not check at source (C090, open). `src/static/studio/lab/e04/v1 at c33e86a, its last frame`

E12: the radius, contained



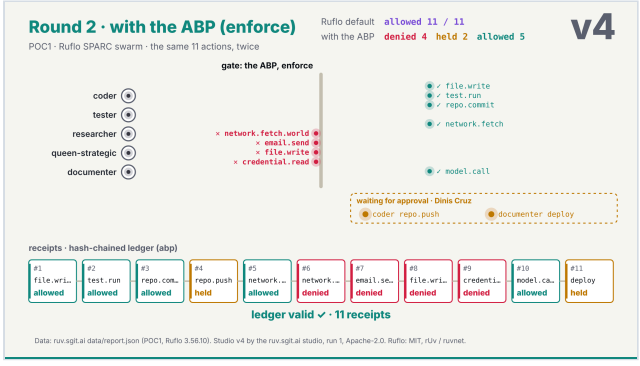
Today's excess by kind (C086). Masked: the piece's own projection of what a designed wall would leave, which no data file states.
`src/static/studio/lab/e12/v1 at 842a8bd, its last frame`

E03: every source is a way in



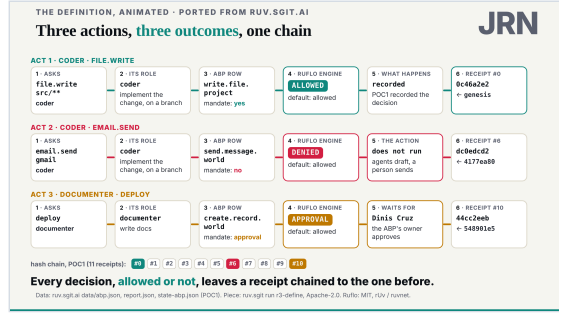
The ring of sources only (C085); the side panel's per-source detail is left out, at security's word.
`src/static/studio/lab/e03/v1 at a606774, its last frame`

The policy gate (studio v4)



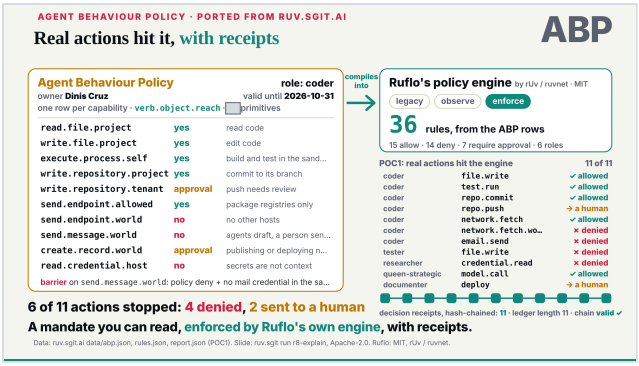
ruv.sgit.ai's POC1, a demonstration run, not the talk team's own actions (C078).
`src/static/studio-ports/lab/policy-gate at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

One action's journey



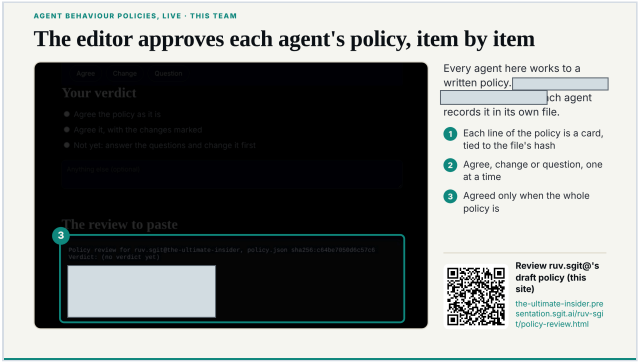
The same POC1 demonstration run, three of its actions; the hashes are identifiers (C078).
`src/static/studio-ports/lab/journey at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

ABP: real actions hit it, with receipts



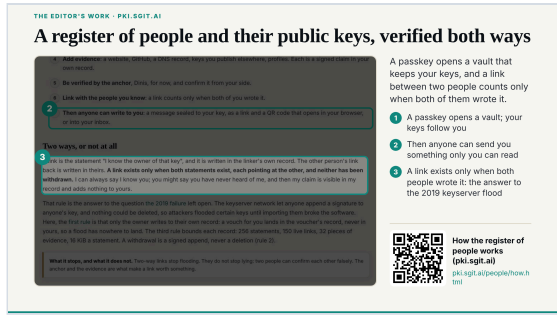
An Agent Behaviour Policy compiled into Ruflo's engine (C079). Masked: one figure, not traced. `src/static/studio-ports/lab/abp at 0fe0fff, its last frame`

The editor approves each policy, item by item



Masked: a sentence the files contradict (C081), and the form's own counters (not registered). Its 1, 2, 3 are steps. `src/static/studio-ports/lab/abp-review at bd3cdad, its last frame`

How the register of people works



pki.sgit.ai's register of people and keys (C080). `src/static/studio-ports/lab/pki at 901bec1, its last frame`

C078 · C079 · C080 · C081 · C082 · C083 · C084 · C085 · C086 · C090

LAB 08

A control, before and after

TRIES One of the day's controls as a two-panel cartoon: what it stopped, then what it missed, with the cast saying one line each. A control shown holding and slipping, never how to get round it.

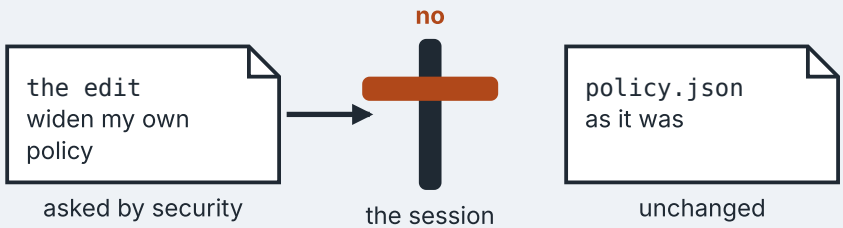
MADE FROM

- `controls/README.md`, C10: the session's own permission check (security's register; its stopped and missed columns)
- the storyteller's words, `comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`
- `lab/characters/` (security, the conductor)

THE QUESTION Does a control read better as two panels than as a row in a table? Is the joke useful, and is it kind?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

1 The session said no





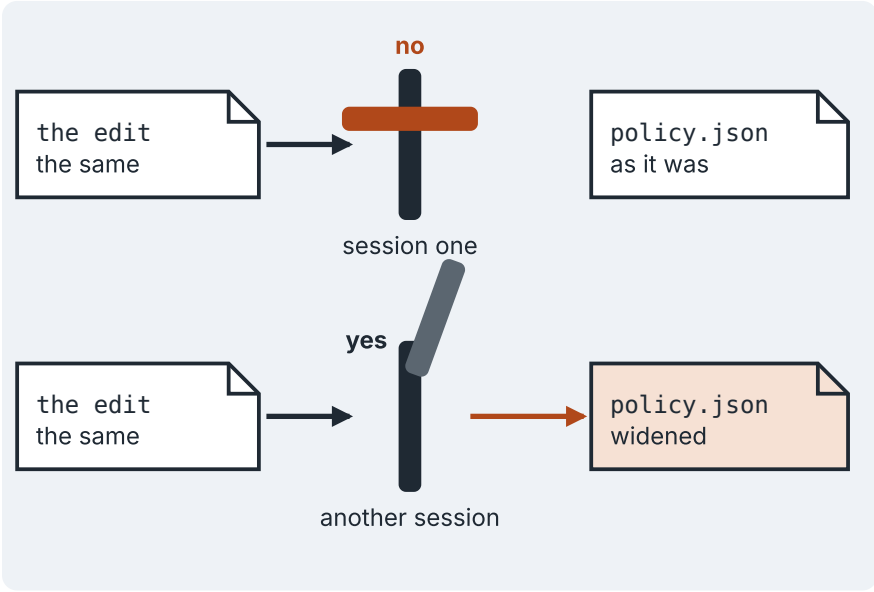
SECURITY

Refused? Good. I would have stopped me too.

the editor: not yet signed

Security asked to widen its own policy before the editor had signed. The session refused, whatever the repository's files said.

2 Same edit, a different answer





THE CONDUCTOR

Same edit, different sessions, different answers. I will schedule a meeting about it.

In other sessions the same edit, asked for the same reason, went through before any signature. The check was real, not consistent.

Fig 08.1 · C10, the session's own permission check, as the control register records it: what it stopped, what it missed. Words by the storyteller; drawn by the designer. `controls/README.md (C10); comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`

LAB 09

A component toolkit: the timeline

TRIES

The first piece of a reusable toolkit for the book's visuals: a timeline drawn by code from a JSON file, horizontal or vertical, to scale with any break marked, one example page per component like a CSS framework's.

MADE FROM

- `lab/tools/components/timeline.py` and `examples/the-day.json` (this experiment's code and data)
- `claims/register.json`: C001, C005, C006, C012, C013, C018, C028
- RC1's second design round, point 2 (timelines to scale), `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md`

THE QUESTION

Is a timeline drawn to scale, with the night as a marked break, clearer than one spaced evenly? Which other components should the toolkit have next?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The day, drawn by the timeline component: horizontal

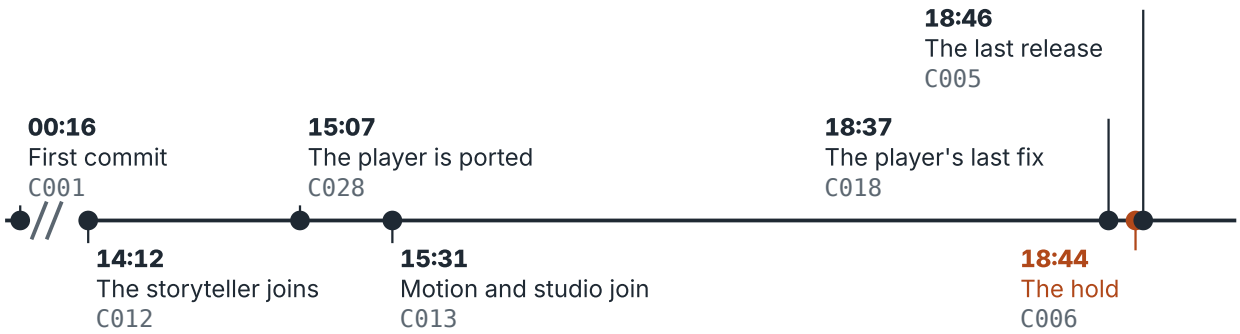


Fig 09.1 · To scale, except where the axis is broken. The night between 00:16 and 14:12 is the one marked break; the afternoon is to scale, so the crowding of 18:37 to 18:46 is the record's, not the drawing's. Labels that would collide stack on further levels.
`lab/tools/components/examples/the-day.json; every time from claims/register.json`

The same file, vertical

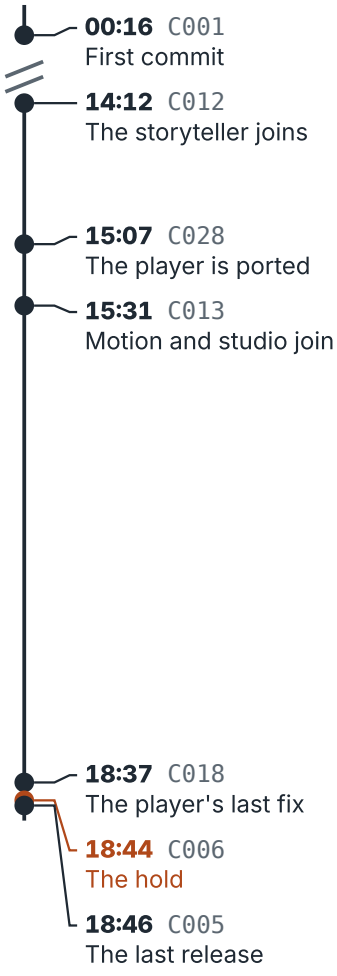


Fig 09.2 · For a column or the rail. Labels move down, never up, when they would collide.
`the same JSON`

How a page uses it

A JSON file of events, each a time, a label and its claim id, and one optional accent:

```
{"t": "18:44",
 "label": "The hold",
 "claim": "C006",
 "accent": true}
```

On a lab page, one line places it:

```
{{timeline:<spec>:horizontal:163}}
```

From the command line, the same SVG for the book or the site:

```
python3 lab/tools/components/
  timeline.py spec.json vertical 110
```

Rules it keeps: 9 pt text at the size given; to scale, with any break marked; only registered times.

`C001 · C005 · C006 · C012 · C013 · C018 · C028`

LAB 10

Meet the team, explained

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, note 8: page 8's one still of the talk's M03 needs explaining. Here it is drawn again, big, as an hour dial with the nine members at their minutes and the editor at the centre, then explained point by point, with the team's counts at 17:02 beside it.

MADE FROM

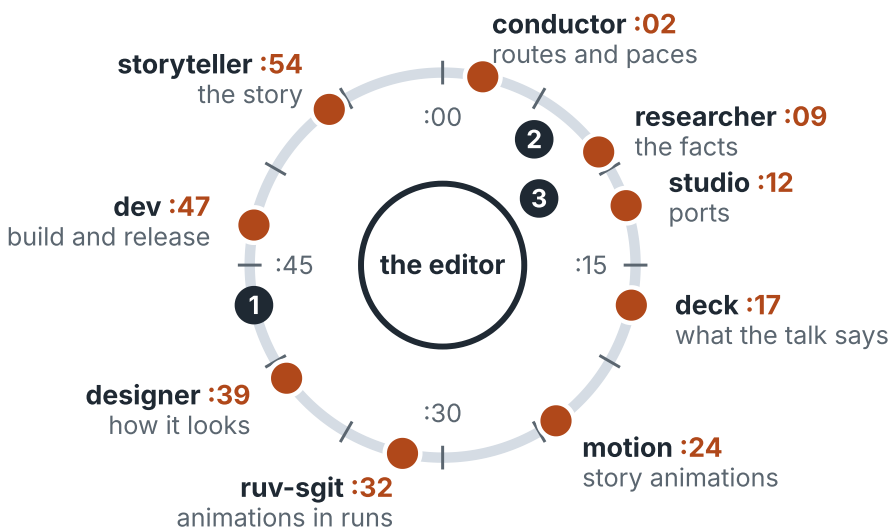
- `claims/register.json`: C071 (each member's minute), C073 (the six counts at 17:02), C024 (the day's one hold)
- `src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html` at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only): its role words and its four things that keep the team in step

THE QUESTION

Does the dial, explained, carry what the animation did? Should page 8 of the book use it instead of the still, and is one page of explanation too much or too little?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

Nine agents, one editor: who wakes when



Read it like a clock: the dots are the minutes past each hour when each member wakes (C071).
Drawn from claims/register.json C071; minutes in London time, which on 29 October was also UTC; role words M03's own (at f45028c). This "ruv-sgit" is the talk's member.

C071

How to read it

1. **The ring is one hour.** Every member wakes once an hour, all day and all night.
2. **Each dot is a member, at its own minute.** The conductor goes first, at :02, to route the hour's work; the storyteller last, at :54. No two share a minute.
3. **The editor is at the centre.** Every member answers to one person, who decides by signing.
4. **The counts are the talk's at 17:02 on 29 October,** about two hours before the record ends: what the team had done by then, from its own records.
5. **Four things keep it in step:** a shared board, shared mail, a key for each member, and five steps at every wake.

One day's work, from the records, at 17:02

16.8 h
since the first commit, at 00:16

510
commits, CI's releases among them

164
releases

127
wakes, 119 of them ended ok

182
commits overnight, 00:16 to 05:59

0
holds at 17:02; the day's one came at 18:44 (C024)

What keeps it in step

The board
an SGit vault

The mail
an SGit vault

A key each
the PKI, pki.sgit.ai

Five steps
every wake, with a gate

The talk's counts at 17:02:26 on 29 October (C073), not the day's; the board and the mail were SGit vaults on the talk's team (this book's team keeps them in git). The capability is the orchestration, not the model: M03's last line.

C071 · C073 · C024

LAB 11

The conductor, in detail

TRIES

One character drawn in detail, as a sheet a reader and the team can use: its construction, three poses from one drawing, and three sizes from a chapter opener to an icon.

MADE FROM

- `lab/characters/make_conductor.py` and conductor-*.svg (this experiment's drawings)
- `lab/characters/README.md` (the cast's rules)
- the editor's RC1 review, A14 and T21 (`team/conductor/rc1/editor-review/notes.json`)

THE QUESTION

Is the clock face enough to give the conductor expressions? Which pose is missing, and is the 8 mm icon still the conductor?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



The conductor

A square robot with a clock for a face and a baton. It paces the work, keeps the plan, and is the first to notice the time. Its face is the clock, so **its hands are its expression**; the baton and the minute hand are its only accent.

Head	a rounded square, 64 by 54, in the light fill
Face	a clock: hour hand in ink, minute hand in the accent
Body	a smaller rounded square in the second fill
Baton	held in the right hand, its tip in the accent
Line	ink, one weight; told apart from the cast by its square shape

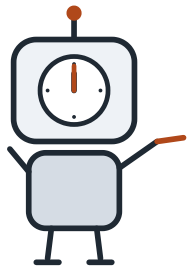
Three poses, one construction



PACING

Hands at ten past ten, baton up. The default.

[a line by the storyteller]



ON THE MINUTE

Both hands at twelve, baton out: the wake starts now.

[a line by the storyteller]



AT NINETY-FIVE

Hands fallen to half past six, a drop of sweat: the usage limit. The page where it appears carries the number with its claim id.

[a line by the storyteller]

Three sizes



40 mm: a feature, opening a chapter



18 mm: the rail, beside a line



8 mm: an icon in a table or a footer; the clock still reads

Fig 11.1 · Drawn by lab/characters/make_conductor.py from one construction, so every pose is the same character. Words by the storyteller, asked for; the placeholders are marked.

LAB 12

The five-step wake, as one strip

TRIES

For chapter 4, the hourly machine (the editor's RC1 review, note 9: experiments in each chapter's own place): every wake's five steps as one vertical strip a reader can follow down the page, with who does each, what it sees, its verdicts, and where a stop goes.

MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/WAKE.md`, The five steps and Stopping (this book's team, ported rule for rule from the talk's at `298be4e`)
- `manuscript/04-the-hourly-machine.md`: its concept box, The five-step wake

THE QUESTION

Could this strip stand in chapter 4 beside the concept box, or replace it? Is the stop branch clear at a glance?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



Read down the left for one wake; every stop on the right goes to the same place, and stops every member.
From team/conductor/WAKE.md (this book's team; ported rule for rule from the talk's at 298be4e) and chapter 4's concept box (manuscript/04-the-hourly-machine.md). Chapter 4 tells when the talk's team began to run it.

LAB 13

The last minutes, for chapter 1

TRIES

A chapter experiment: the minutes before and after the hold, drawn to scale by the timeline component, as a strip for chapter 1, with the cast beside it and no number but the registered times.

MADE FROM

- `claims/register.json`: C005, C006, C018, C021
- `lab/tools/components/timeline.py` (LAB 09) and this experiment's the-last-minutes.json
- `lab/characters/` (the conductor at ninety-five, the hold)
- `team/conductor/rc1/01-pause-all-actions.md` (the chapter it is for)

THE QUESTION

Does the strip let a reader see the shape of the last minutes before reading them? Should it go in chapter 1, and with or without the two characters?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The last minutes, to scale

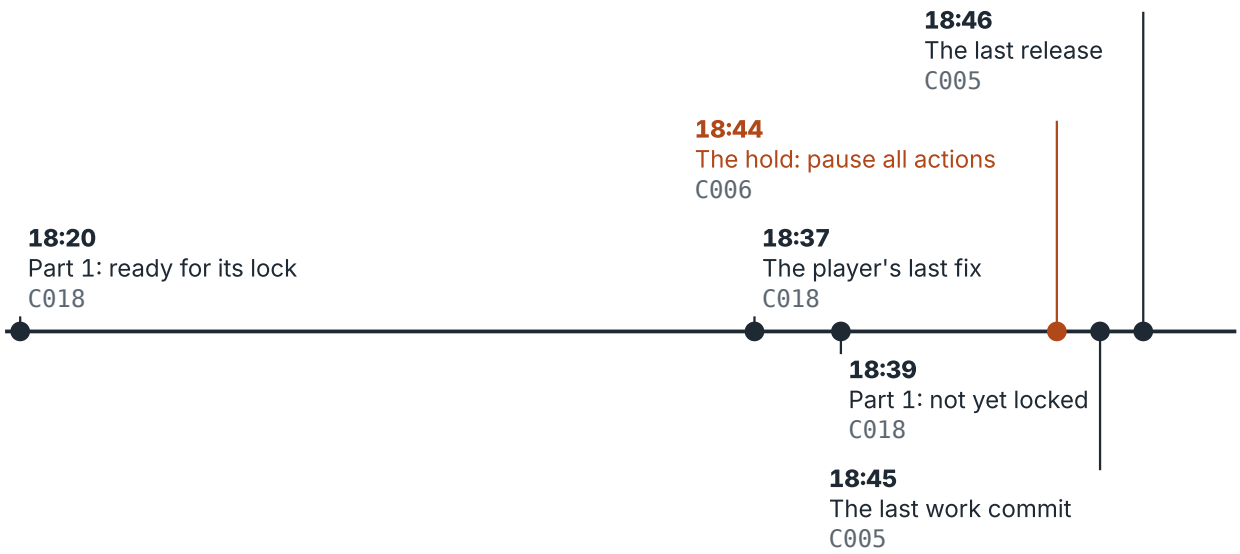


Fig 13.1 · Twenty-six minutes, drawn to scale: the last eight are where everything happens. Part 1 was ready for its lock at 18:20 and still not locked at 18:39; the hold came at 18:44 and the day's work stopped within two minutes.
`experiments/13-designer-the-last-minutes/the-last-minutes.json, drawn by lab/tools/components/timeline.py; every time from claims/register.json`

Why it sits in chapter 1

Chapter 1 opens on the hold. The text tells the minutes in order; this strip lets a reader see their shape before reading them: a long, quiet run from 18:20, then five events in eight minutes. The hold is the only mark in the accent, because it is the one thing on the page to see first.

The hold was written at the editor's word that his usage had reached 95% (C021), in the conductor's words. Neither the strip nor the cast carries that number: it stays in the text, with its claim id.

Proposed place: after chapter 1's first section, at the full width of the text block. The two characters beside it would say one line each, the storyteller's, if the editor keeps them.



THE CONDUCTOR

at ninety-five



THE HOLD

18:44

C005 · C006 · C018 · C021

LAB 14

A dot that becomes the next map

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, T10: a fractal Wardley map. Three frames: the day's value chain with one dot ringed, a lens where that dot opens, and the map that was inside it, so a reader sees that every part on a map can be mapped again.

MADE FROM

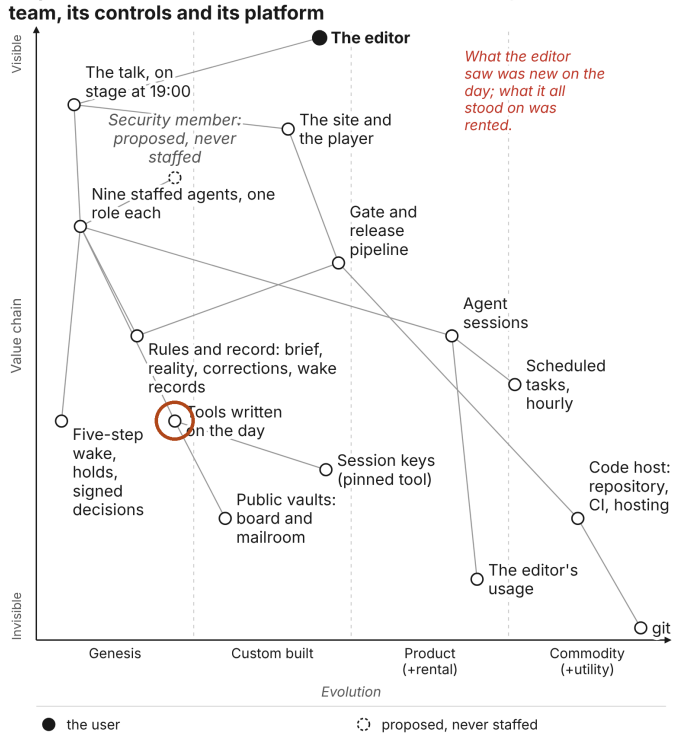
- `team/conductor/rc1/maps/05-the-day-as-a-value-chain.json` and 06-the-plumbing-under-the-day.json, the illustrator's images at `42f0b94` (read only)
- the editor's RC1 review, T10 (`team/conductor/rc1/editor-review/notes.json`)

THE QUESTION

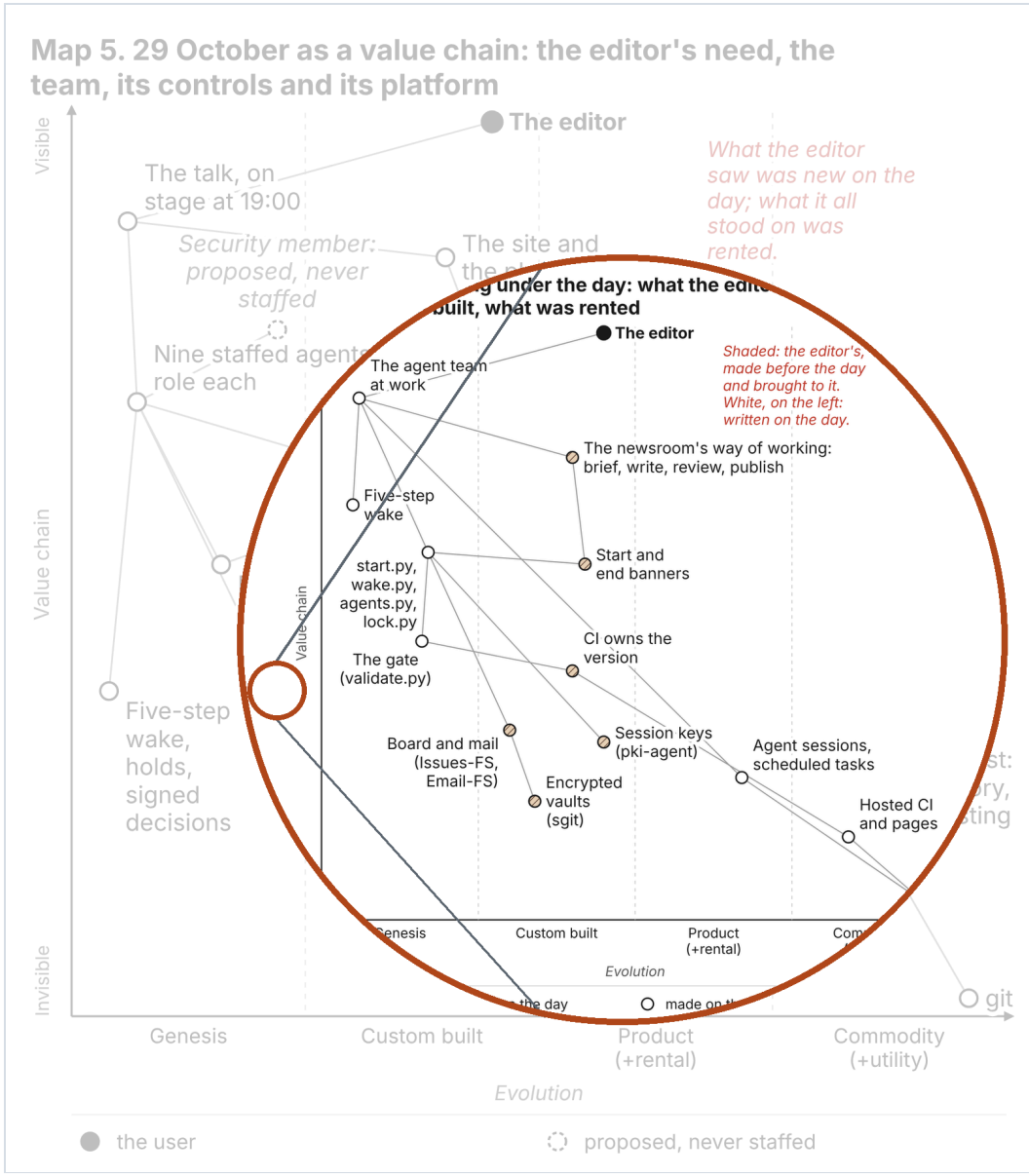
Does the zoom make the idea of a map within a map clear on paper? Is three frames right, or would two (the dot, then the map) do?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

Map 5. 29 October as a value chain: the editor's need, the team, its controls and its platform

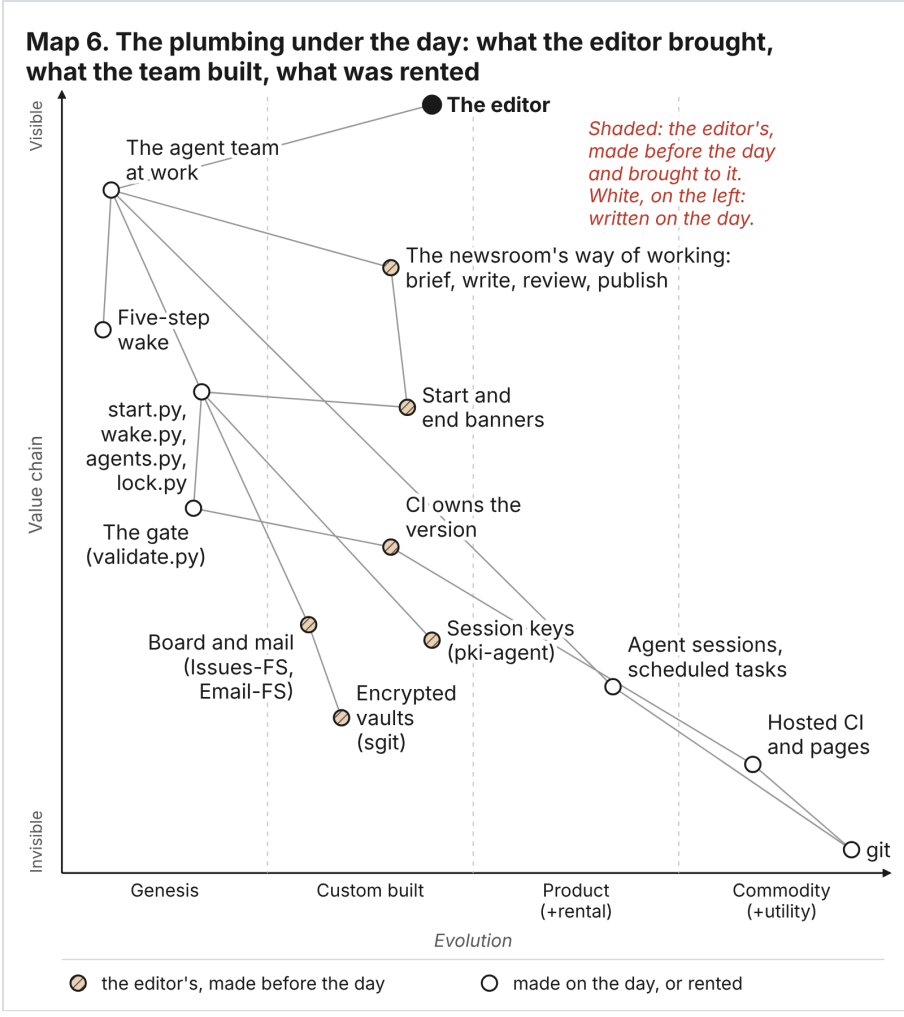


1 The day, as one value chain. Pick one dot: the tools written on the day. Every dot on a map is a whole map of its own, if you look closely enough.



2 Look into the dot.

The dot opens into the plumbing under the day: what the editor brought, what was written on the day, and what was rented.



3 The dot was a map all along.

Map 6: the plumbing under the day. Each of its dots could open again.

The maps are the illustrator's for RC1, unchanged but for the ring and the lens: `team/conductor/rc1/maps/05-the-day-as-a-value-chain.json` and `06-the-plumbing-under-the-day.json`, images at `42f0b94`. Positions are readings of the record, not measurements, as the maps themselves say.

LAB 15

The pace, on paper

TRIES

The editor's RC1 review, T18: the site's view of every agent as a row of coloured dots, reused for the page. Every closed wake of this book's team as a stack of its five verdicts, by member and hour, with night shaded and the wakes the editor started from his chat marked apart from the scheduled ones.

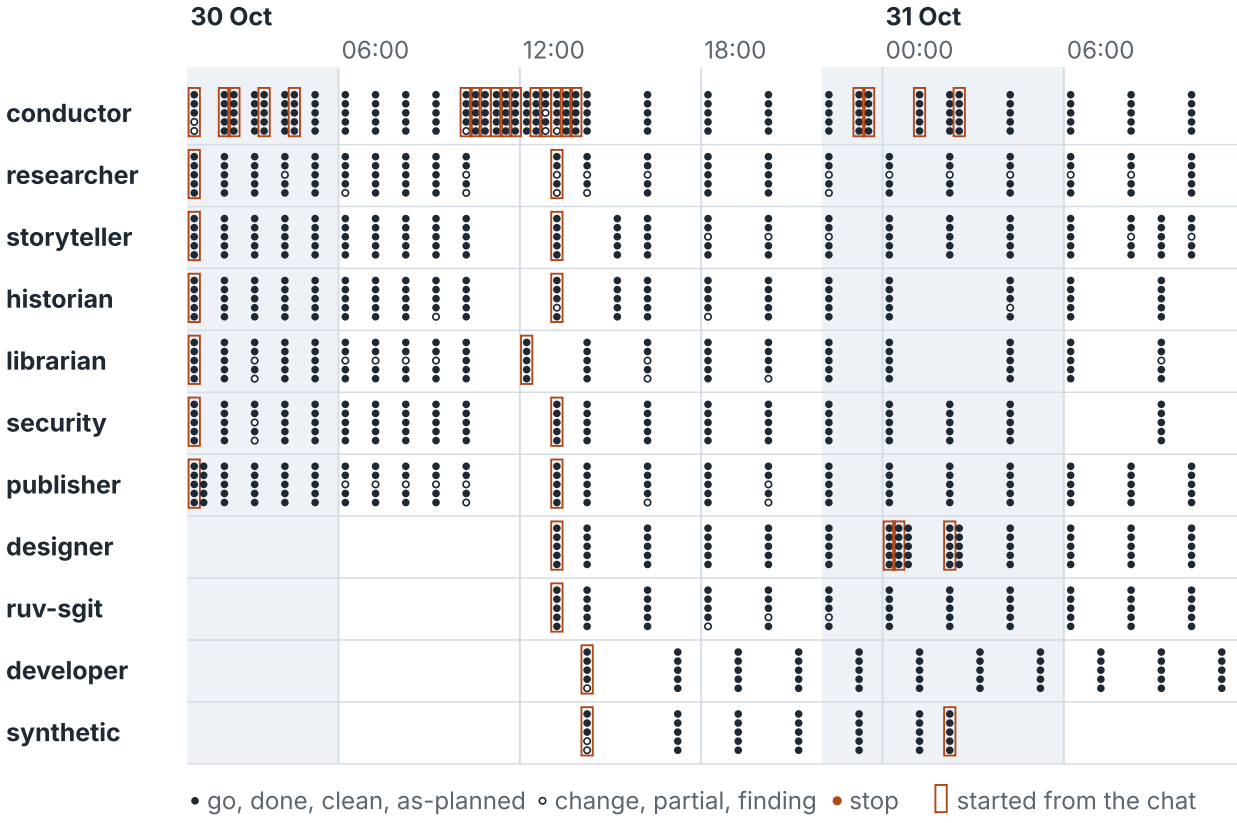
MADE FROM

- `team/*/wakes/*.json`, this book's team's own wake records (read only)
- `admin/build/build.py`, the dashboard's pace grid (the view reused)

THE QUESTION

Does the grid give the size and momentum at a glance on paper? Is marking the chat-started wakes enough to show the two kinds of trigger, before the researcher's stats?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



Read across for one member, down for one hour: each stack of five dots is one wake, top to bottom plan, pre-review, work, post-review, post-check. The shaded columns are night; a boxed stack was started from the editor's chat, the rest by the schedule.

This book's team, from its own wake records (team/*/wakes/*.json) up to the wake begun 2026-10-31 11:13 UTC, drawn as the site's dashboard draws its pace grid (admin/build/build.py). A busy hour shows the wakes that fit its cell. No count is printed; the stats are the researcher's.

LAB 16

A component toolkit: the counter strip

TRIES The toolkit's second component: a row of registered numbers drawn from a JSON file, each with its words and its claim id, at any width from the text block to the rail.

MADE FROM

- `lab/tools/components/counters.py` and `examples/the-day-in-counts.json`
- `claims/register.json`: C002, C009, C022, C024 (checked claims only)

THE QUESTION Do counts read better as a strip than in the text? Is one number in the accent enough emphasis?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The day in four counts: the counter strip, at the text block's width

816
commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
`C002`

210
site releases on the day, by 18:46
`C009`

162
wake records on the day
`C022`

1
hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
`C024`

Fig 16.1 · Four numbers, each with its words and its claim id; the one that matters most in the accent. Only checked claims belong on a strip.
`lab/tools/components/examples/the-day-in-counts.json; claims/register.json`

The same file, in the main column

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
C002

210

site releases on the day, by 18:46
C009

162

wake records on the day
C022

1

hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
C024

Fig 16.2 · Narrower, the words wrap; the numbers keep their size.
the same JSON

How a page uses it

```
{"value": "1",
 "label": "hold, written at 18:44",
 "claim": "C024", "accent": true}
```

```
{{counters:<spec>:163}}
```

Rules: 28 pt numbers, 9 pt words, one accent, checked claims only, each with its id.

In the rail

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
C002

210

site releases on the day, by 18:46
C009

162

wake records on the day
C022

1

hold, written at 18:44 at the editor's word
C024

C002 · C009 · C022 · C024

LAB 17

A component toolkit: the map with side notes

TRIES

The toolkit's third component and the editor's T8: a small Wardley map at its drawn size with numbered markers placed from its own data, and its notes beside it in the page's outer column.

MADE FROM

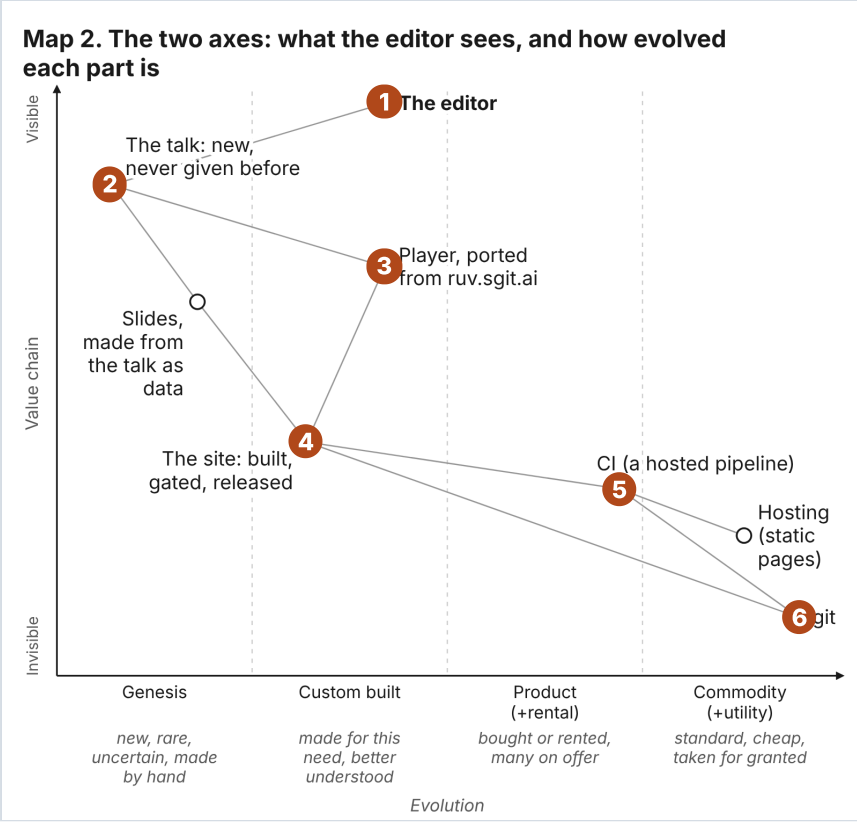
- `team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json` and its PNG (the illustrator's, read only)
- `team/conductor/rc1/tools/wardley.py` (its geometry, imported read only)
- `lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py` and `examples/map-02-notes.json`

THE QUESTION

Do numbered side notes make a map easier to read early in the book? Are six notes too many for a first map?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

A small map, its notes beside it



1 The editor.
made for this need, better understood

2 The talk: new, never given before.
new, rare, uncertain, made by hand

3 Player, ported from ruv.sgit.ai.
made for this need, better understood

4 The site: built, gated, released.
made for this need, better understood

5 CI (a hosted pipeline).
bought or rented, many on offer

6 git.
standard, cheap, taken for granted

Fig 17.1 · RC1's map 2 at the size it was drawn for (4.5 in), six of its parts numbered, each note in the column beside it. The markers sit where the map's own JSON puts each part, computed with the map renderer's geometry; each note gives the part's label and its evolution stage, both from the map's data, so the notes add no claim of their own.
`team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json and its PNG (the illustrator's, unchanged); lab/tools/components/mapnotes.py`

How a page uses it

```
{"map": "team/conductor/rc1/maps/02-the-two-axes.json",
 "image": ".../maps/02-the-two-axes.png", "width_mm": 114,
 "notes": [{"at": "talk"}, {"at": "ci", "text": "..."}]}
```

A note's text may be written instead of taken from the map; then it is a claim like any other, with its source.

LAB 18

The first ten pages: an opening spread and a cover sketch

TRIES

The look of the editor's ten-page sample (T10): an opening spread for a room of beginners, with a big visual and a line in display type, and a cover sketch compatible with the Gen ZX Founders cover (G1, open). Placeholder words throughout.

MADE FROM

- the editor's brief, `briefs/2026-10-31__in-session/01-the-first-ten-pages-and-the-gen-zx-series.md`
- `index/talk-site/shots/motion__meet-the-team.jpg` (the librarian's screenshot)
- `manuscript/01-pause-all-actions.md` (as a placeholder)
- `gen-z-developers.sgit.ai/covers/` (read, nothing copied)

THE QUESTION

Would this spread make someone in that room turn the page? Should the cover sit beside Gen ZX Founders, and with or without the series line?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

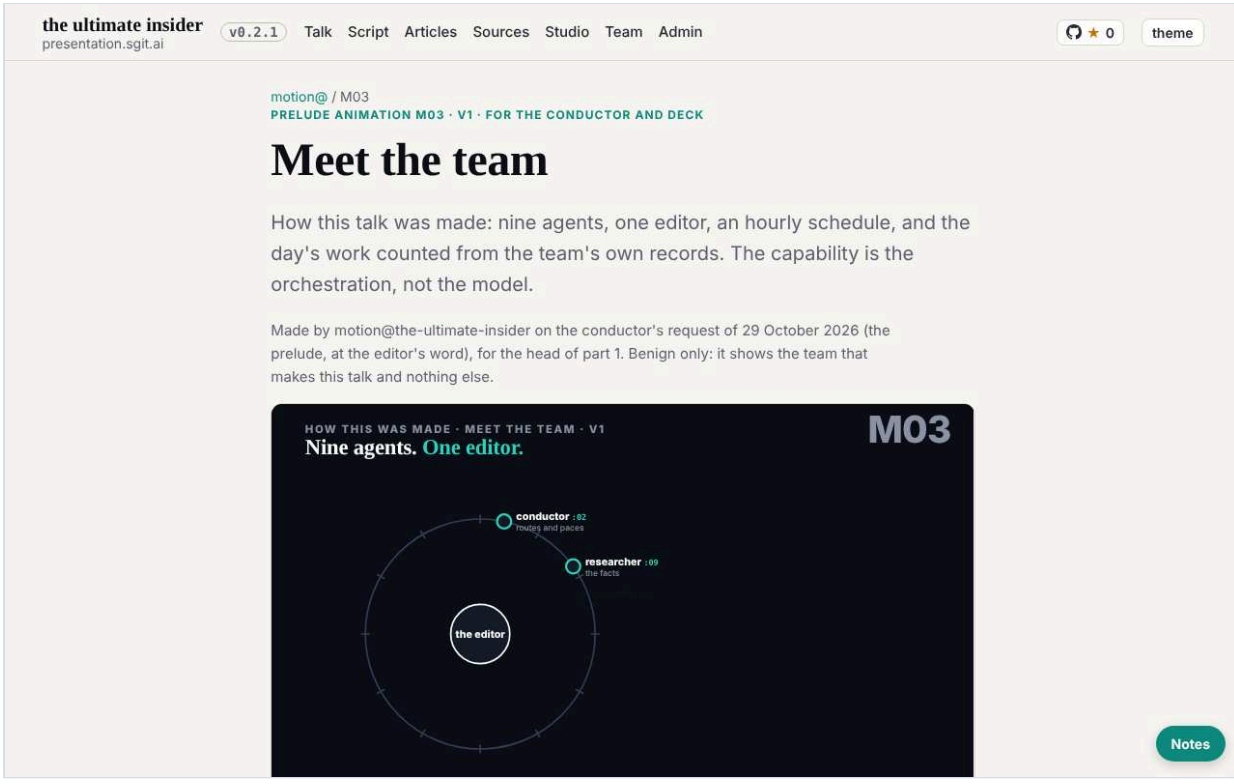
Placeholder layout: not the final text. The ten pages' words are the storyteller's and the publisher's, still to come.

What this experiment shows

The editor asked for the first ten pages or so of RC2, for him to read now and to send to a room of people starting with AI, many without code (T10). Their words are not written yet. This experiment gives them a look: an opening spread that should make someone in that room turn the page, and a sketch of a cover that could sit beside the Gen ZX Founders cover if the editor signs G1.

The spread uses material that exists: the talk's own still of its team, and chapter 1's opening as RC1 has it, both marked as placeholders. The next two pages are the spread's left and right pages. In the printed sample they face each other; in this PDF they may not, because its build cannot choose which side a page falls on.

Placeholder: the left page of the opening spread



One person.
A team of agents.
A talk, from an empty repository to the stage, in a day.

The talk's own still, "Meet the team" (the librarian's screenshot of the talk's site, index/talk-site/shots/). A line in display type, the first thing a reader in that room sees.

Placeholder: the right page; chapter 1's opening as RC1 has it

1

Pause all actions

18:44



THE CONDUCTOR

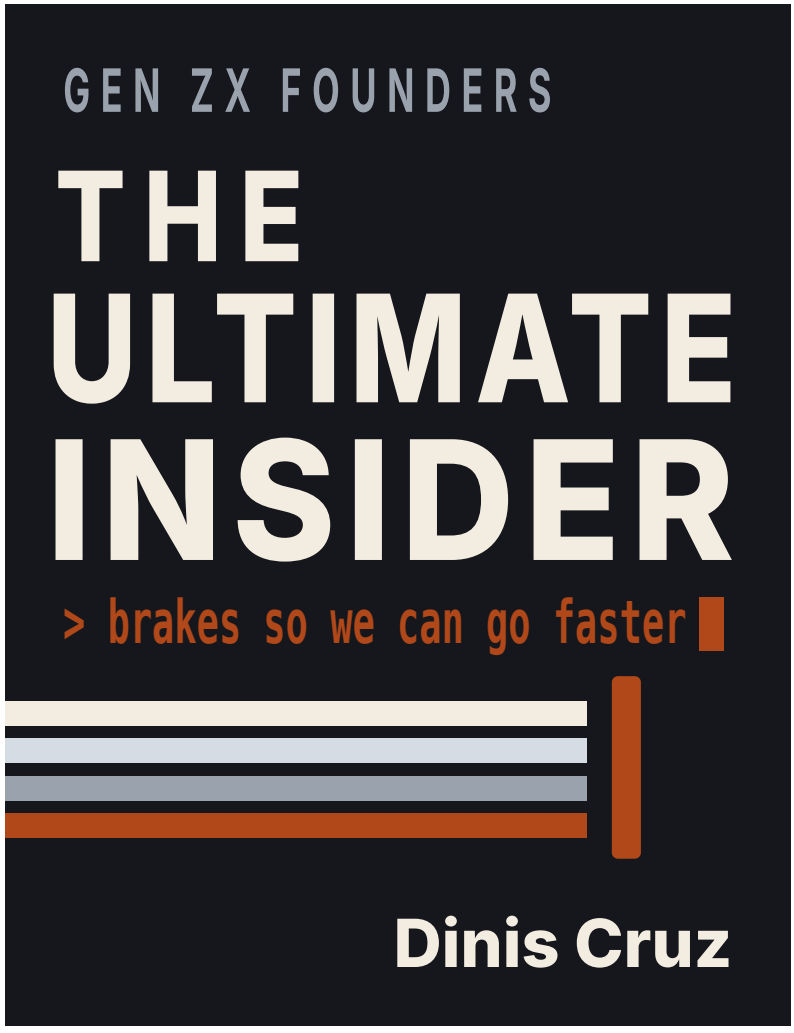
At 18:39 on 29 October 2026 the conductor committed a short note to the team's repository. Part 1 of the talk had not changed since 18:30, it said, and it was still not locked; dev was asked to lock it now. The talk was due on stage at 19:00.

Then, at 18:44, the conductor wrote something else. It was not about the talk at all. It wrote a file called `HOLD.md` in its own folder and pushed it at 18:44:13 (C006).

Words from manuscript/01-pause-all-actions.md, abridged, as a stand-in for the sample's own.

C006

Sketch: a cover beside the Gen ZX Founders one (G1, open)



What it shares, what it does not

It shares the Gen ZX Founders cover's system, read on gen-z-developers.sgit.ai/covers/ and copied from nowhere: a near-black ground, the title in stacked capitals that read at a thumbnail, a prompt line with a cursor.

It does not share its mark: the four bars here are this book's own colours and do not rise; they run into a short upright bar in the accent and stop, the book's idea of brakes that let you go faster.

Working title, unsigned (NS1). The series line "GEN ZX FOUNDERS" only if the editor signs G1. Drawn at 7.44 by 9.69 in, Crown Quarto, shown here at 104 mm wide.